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PH LUZERN
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Ethics and Scientific Integrity

Campus Lucerne

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Schedule

1 Ethics Committees

2 Brief overview on research ethics

3 How would an ethics commitee decide?

4 Take Home Message

5 Q&A

Types of Ethics Committees

- National Advisery Commission on Biomedical Ethics
- Federal Ethics Committee on Non-Human Biotechnology
  - Set the standards
- Swiss Ethics Committees on research involving humans (mandated by the Federal Office of Public Health and the Conference of Cantonal Ministers of Public Health
  - mainly research on humans (clinical research, neuroscience, pharmacology)
- Inhouse Ethics Committees at universities, hospitals and psychiatric clinics

List of ethics committees in Switzerland (ECs)

The 7 Ethics Committees in Switzerland.
The websites linked below provide contacts detailes and local specific information.

Kantonale Ethikkommission Bern
cantons BE, FR (in German), VS (in German)
link

Ethikkommission Nordwest- und Zentralschweiz EKNZ
cantons AG, BL, BS, JU, LU, NW, OW, SO, SZ, UR, ZG
link

Ethikkommission Ostschweiz EKOS
cantons AI, AR, SG, TG
link

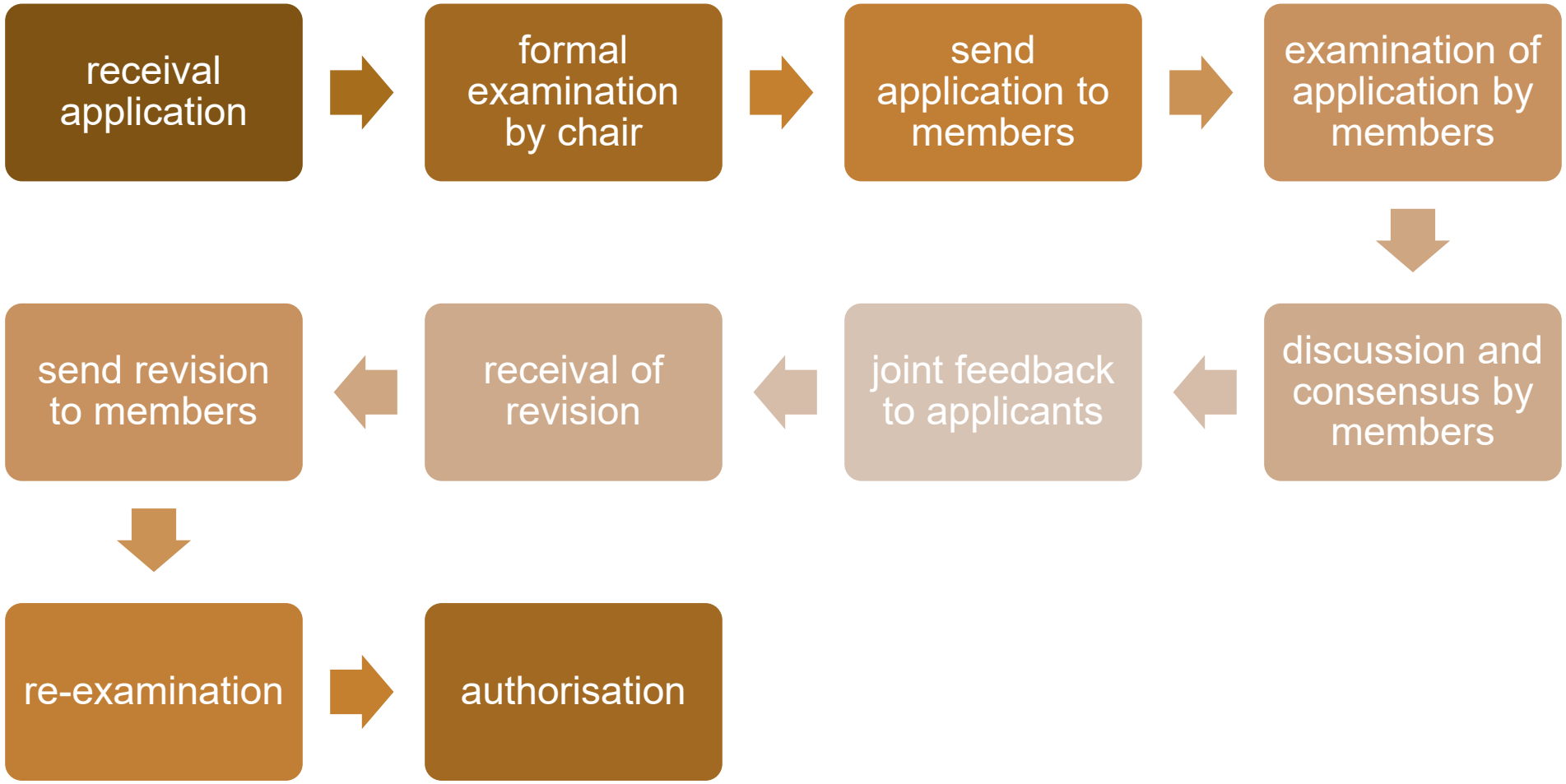
Commission Cantonale d'Ethique de la Recherche sur l'être humain (CCER)
canton Geneva
link

Ethikkommission Tessin
canton Ticino
link

Commission cantonale d'éthique de la recherche sur l'être humain CER-VD
cantons VD, FR (in French), VS (in French), NE
link

Ethikkommission Zürich
cantons GL,GR, SH, ZH, Liechtenstein
link

Process


receival application
formal examination by chair
send application to members
examination of application by members
discussion and consensus by members
joint feedback to applicants
receival of revision
send revision to members
re-examination
authorisation

What we talk about,

Ethics

> analyses human practice with regard to its ethical quality and assesses it critically and reasonably

> examines the conditions under which human behaviour can be considered good

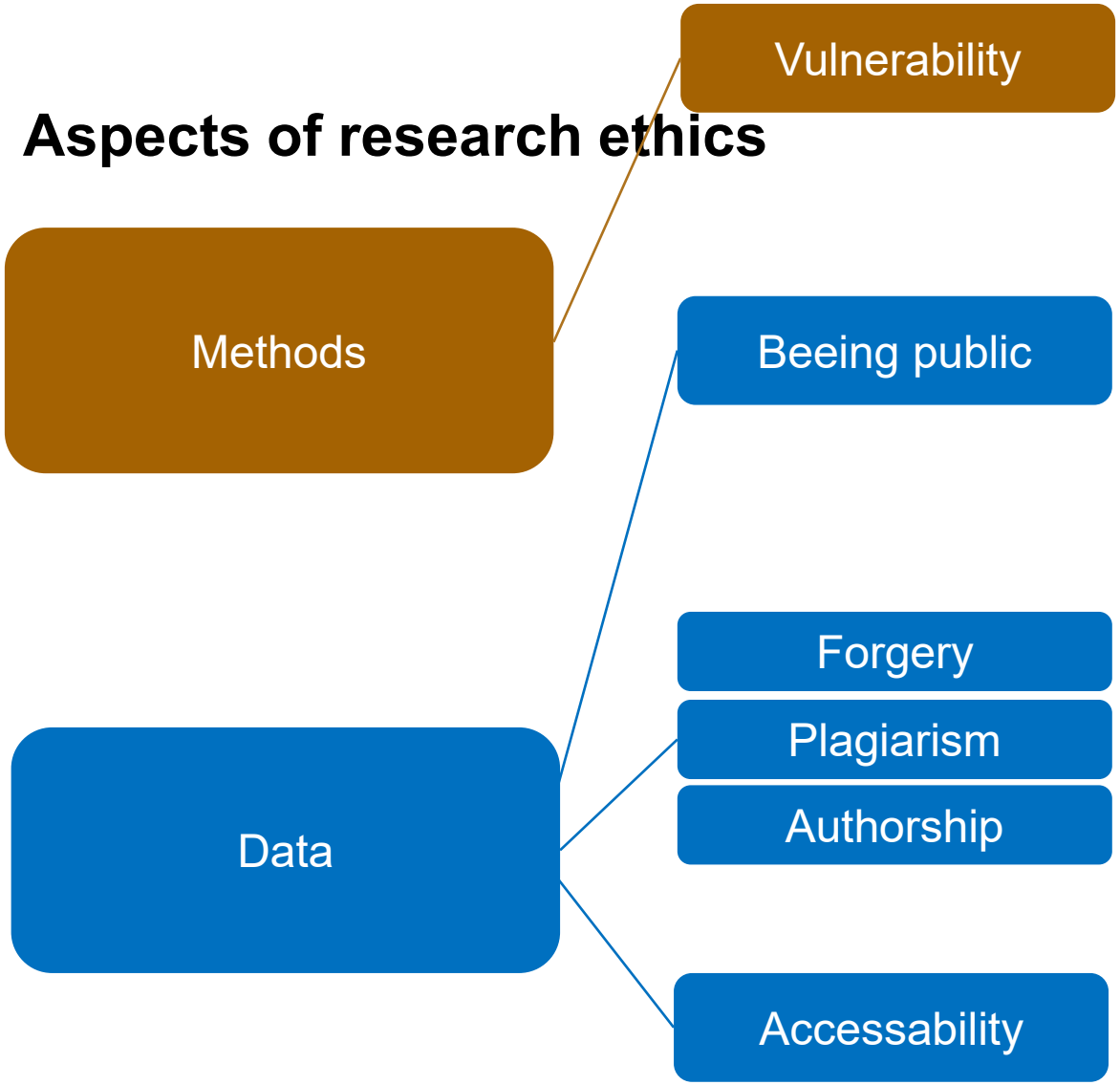
Ethics of research

> ethical reflection on research as a practice

> is orientated towards philosophy and the applicable legal provisions

> formulates rules of good scientific practice

Aspects of research ethics



responsibility towards the participants

Reasonableness of research situation → Dignity Transperancy

Anonymity → Privacy

responsibility towards the scientific community and the public

Authenticity of data and results → Honesty

Common property → Unselfishness

Principles

informed consent
- Information about process
- authorisation to conduct and use data

ethical prognosis
- Vulnerability assessment
- Effect on participants

ethical prevention
- Protection of participants
- Planning crisis intervention in emergency

data protection
- Legally compliant survey, evaluation and processing personal data

What should an ethics committee look out for?

The Special Needs Education Concordat and the Disability Equality Act (BehiG) require the inclusive education of children with disabilities. The principle applies that inclusive solutions are preferable to separate ones. Nevertheless, 3.2 per cent of all schoolchildren in Switzerland are taught separately. Transfers from special schools to mainstream schools (partial and reintegration processes) are rarely observed in practice - they are considered isolated cases.
In order to shed more light on these processes, interviews are conducted with school stakeholders (parents with reintegrated children, teachers, special needs teachers, head teachers, etc.) who have accompanied these processes. The findings from the interviews are presented on a website in the form of portraits, which are available in an accessible format and in various languages. In addition to providing a basis of information on partial and reintegration, the website also offers exchange opportunities for those involved in the school sector. The project thus makes an important contribution to the equality and integration of people with disabilities.

References

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Heinrichs, B. (2023). Forschungs- und Wissenschaftsethik. In: Neuhäuser, C., Raters, ML., Stoecker, R. (eds) Handbuch Angewandte Ethik. J.B. Metzler, Stuttgart.

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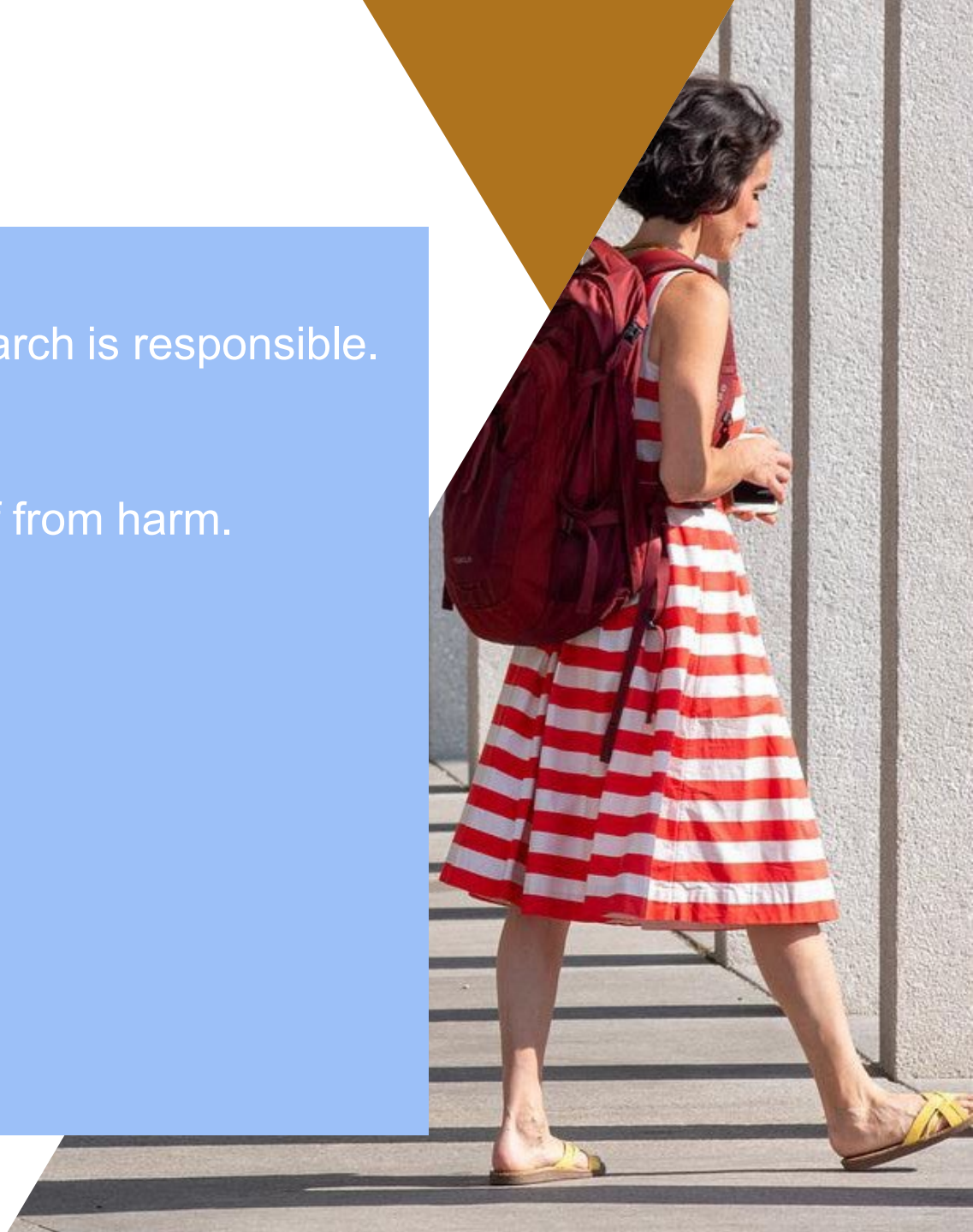
Swissethics https://swissethics.ch/en/ethikkommissionen

Take Home Message

- Research ethics reflects on the extent to which research is responsible.
- In doing so, it refers to moral standards in society.
- It serves to protect the participants and science itself from harm.